

Title of Lab exercise-I: Listening skills: Process of listening, Types, Barriers in listening, Tips for being a good listener.

Objective of the exercise: To be able to learn and demonstrate the skills required for being an effective/active listener.

Preamble of the exercise:

Many individuals typically overlook the act of listening, considering it as a natural occurrence. It is only when you reflect on the process of listening and its components that you come to understand that it is, in truth, a vital skill that must be cultivated and enhanced. Being a good/effective listener helps in developing and sustaining personal and professional relationships. Every one of us wanted to get listened than merely heard.

Following is the typical and fundamental difference between hearing and listening:

1. Hearing involves the sounds that reach your ears and is a natural function that occurs automatically if you don't have any hearing issues. On the other hand, listening demands more; it necessitates active attention and concentrated effort, both mentally and occasionally physically as well.
2. Listening involves focusing not just on the narrative itself, but also on the way it is conveyed, the choice of words and tone, and the way the speaker utilizes their body language. In other words, it entails being cognizant of both spoken and unspoken signals. Your capacity to listen well is influenced by how well you recognize and interpret these signals.
3. Listening is not merely a passive activity. The listener ought to be just as involved in the communication as the speaker is. The term 'active listening' refers to the concept of being completely engaged and synced in this process.

To progress the journey towards an active listener, it is important to know/introspect the status of current listening level and type.

Following are the types of listening based on the attitude, purpose and action during the process of the listening.

- | | |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------|
| a) Informational listening | e) Comprehensive listening |
| b) Discriminative listening | f) Empathetic listening |
| c) Selective listening | g) Critical listening |
| d) Sympathetic listening | h) Reflective listening |
| i) Appreciative listening | |

Brief attributions of above types of listening are as follows:

- a) Informational listening : This type is generally suitable to earn the knowledge based on the information being listened. Concentration and relevance to the content for usage are the most significant attribution for this type of listening.
- b) Discriminative listening: This type of skill is born gifted to everyone. Rather than relying on the words spoken, tone of the word utterance, body language and other nonverbal communication traits are central to this listening skill.
- c) Selective listening: Selective listening, frequently referred to as biased listening, involves attending solely to information that one desires to hear. This phenomenon of selective listening may occur either consciously or unconsciously and can result in unintentional misunderstandings or partial decision-making.
- d) Sympathetic listening: Emotion strongly influences sympathetic listening. Instead of focussing on the speaker's words, the listener concentrates on the speaker's emotions to interpret what is being said without judging or interrupting. When you take the time to listen in this way, the speaker should feel heard and validated. In order to have meaningful interactions, you must listen with empathy.
- e) Comprehensive listening: This type of listening relies more on to understanding the words through acquired knowledge of language and grammar. Comprehensive listening goes matched with disseminative with a subtle difference of not being obvious ability.
- f) Empathetic listening: While sympathetic listening aims to understand a person's feelings and emotions to offer support, empathetic listening goes a step further by

enabling the listener to relate to the speaker's experience as if it were their own. Empathetic listening, also known as empathic listening or therapeutic listening, helps you understand other people's perspectives and visualise yourself in their shoes. Instead of just focussing on the conversation, you use therapeutic listening to relate to a speaker's experiences as if they were your own.

- g) Critical listening: This listening skill type support to understand speaker messages in broader context by allowing you to understand beyond obvious rather than just decoding the messages. Analytical and problem-solving ability is an outcome of this type of listening skill.
- h) Reflective listening: One way to actively show that you hear, comprehend, and digest the speaker's message is through reflective listening. After that, you relay the information to them to make sure they understand it right. Reflective listening avoids misunderstandings and promotes more fruitful conversations by providing context for what you heard.
- i) Appreciative listening: This form of listening not only serve the basic purpose of understanding but march ahead to affirm the positive loop between communicating parties. The goal of appreciative listening is to listen for enjoyment. It is based on your thoughts and feelings and is subjective. You can even improve your health and wellbeing by practicing appreciative listening.

Barriers in being a good listener:

Barriers in being a good listener primarily related to the human attributions like attitude, intention, prejudice, perceived mindset etc. Open mindedness (mindfulness) in the process of listening is a must to receive and perceive an information for it's intended purpose. Some of the significant considerations as a barrier in the listening process are-

- 1) Not being attentive
- 2) Mental disturbances
- 3) Physical disturbances
- 4) Predication to react
- 5) Questioning mind during the process of listening
- 6) Preconceived thoughts
- 7) Inpatient/pretentious to understanding

Tips for being a good listener is inclusive to the process of avoiding or minimizing the barriers mentioned above with the best of ability and rational attitude and intention of listening.

Guidelines for the conduct of the exercise:

1. This exercise to be performed individually.
2. Students are expected to watch a short video of their choice and understand their type of listening (Self-evaluation with reasons).
3. Exemplification of the event or phenomenon for types of listening.
4. Based on theoretic guidelines, repeat the listening of video and observe the difference between level of comprehension and take away from the video.
5. Summarize the learning and outcome of this exercise with an appropriate brief writeup.

CO-PO Mapping strength and Justification:

CO	PO	CO-PO mapping strength	Mapping Justification
Evaluate the listening skills	PO 09	3	Potential attainment will address the ability to synergize among the team members as a team member or team leader and mapped strongly PO-09. Also, strongly support effective communication in the group (PO-10). This ability is also referred to sustaining as a lifelong learning process and being mapped strongly (PO-12)
	PO 10	3	
	PO 12	3	

Evaluation Guidelines/Parameters:

1. Individual evaluation,
2. Evaluation for the self-analysis towards level and type of learner.
3. Example demonstrating the type of listening.
4. Demonstration of the effectiveness of listening of a short video.
5. Brief report on student's exercise.

Prepared by
Prof.Dr. Shailesh Kulkarni
VIT-Pune (Kondhwa campus)